

1. Conduct offer comparison discussion using slide deck template
1. Follow up with decision maker on move to SaaS
1. Suggest PS for migration

Discovery Questions

We recommend asking champions some discovery questions during a cadence call to gauge why they want to move to SaaS and ensure that certain access control items, features, and APIs are not currently of utmost importance to the business before kicking off the migration process.

Discovery Questions

1. What prompted this move to SaaS?
1. What are you hoping to accomplish as a result of moving to SaaS?
 - Infrastructure cost savings?
 - Automatic GitLab version upgrades to stay up-to-date?
 - If the customer does not give these reasons, we should explore their reasoning to see if it is worth them moving to SaaS.
1. What features are you using on the admin panel?
 - Are these accessible on SaaS?
 - Are you utilizing the GitLab API to do things that require admin privileges?
 - If the customer switches to SaaS, they will not be able to use the admin panel OR perform API calls that require admin access.
1. Have you completed a security audit of our SaaS solution to ensure it is compliant to your organization's standards?
 - If the customer answers NO, we recommend their security team performs any required audits in advance to ensure SaaS is compliant with their security requirements.
1. What are your access control security requirements?
1. What are you using for authentication?
 - SAML SSO? LDAP?
1. What is your process for Provisioning and deprovisioning?
1. How do you handle access management?
1. Are you using a provider such as Okta?
 - If the customer answers YES, they could restrict IP access at the identity provider level via a setting in Okta or a similar tool.
1. Are you using 2-Factor Authentication?
1. Do any of your employees use Personal Access Tokens (PATs) to perform git actions?
 - If the customer answers YES, we should discuss:
 - How we cannot restrict PATs to certain IP addresses
 - How on SaaS you cannot view or revoke any PATs except the ones you own
 - How on SaaS you cannot programmatically revoke PATs via the API
1. Do you use a VPN?
1. What requirements do you have around accessing code bases outside of the corporate network?
1. Do your employees ever need to access your code base off of the corporate network?
 - If the customer answers YES, we DO NOT need to explore gitlab-sshd and the IP allowlisting bug, since they would be accessing the code base outside of an allow-listed VPN.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/_index.md

View the Customer Success Handbook homepage for additional related handbook pages.

Overview

The Customer Success team is distributed across different customer segments, depending on the customer's Annual Recurring Revenue or the purchase of GitLab's Success Plan Services (SPS).

Segments

<button class="btn btn-primary" type="button">CSM</button>
<button class="btn btn-primary" type="button">CSE</button>
<button class="btn btn-primary" type="button">CSA</button>
<button class="btn btn-primary" type="button">Renewals Managers</button>

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/amer.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Overview

CSMs aligned with AMER customers can use this handbook page to help define their processes and approaches that are unique to their segment. CSMs may have both Enterprise and Commercial accounts as defined by Sales segments.

Customer Lifecycle Journey:

Source

CSM Activities

Align & Onboard

Transitioning an account to a CSM during the pre-sales cycle helps the CSM set expectations early in the relationship and ensures a seamless experience as the prospect becomes a customer and enters onboarding. Aligning on a Success Plan and onboarding is critical to getting a customer started on a successful journey with GitLab. This is our opportunity to ensure the customer achieves value and success from the start of their GitLab usage. It also sets expectations on joint goals and the collaboration between the customer and GitLab.

| Description | Metrics |

|---|---|

Account transition & introduction, where the CSM is introduced to the prospect at the Negotiation stage of the Sales cycle.	Time to first engage = 14 days
A Success Plan is a roadmap that connects a customer's desired business outcomes to GitLab. This focus ensures that we are spending time on ensuring customer success and growth while defending customer retention.	100% management-qualified green Success Plans
Onboarding in order to get the customer to first value as soon as possible, including setting expectations for the CSM and customer relationship and establish regular check-in calls.	- Time to first engage = 14 days - Time to first value = 30 days - Time to onboard = 45 days

Enable

The primary objective in enabling our customers is to get a customer to value quickly, ensuring any roadblocks to adoption are removed and the customer is at a state of maturity in their desired use cases to provide platform value early on. We continue to drive adoption on use cases beyond first value through workshops and webinars, explore opportunities to increase maturity in primary use cases through more advanced workshops and establish executive alignment through EBRs.

| Description | Metrics |

|---|---|

Primary use case enablement to ensure the customer gets value quickly and ROI for their reason for purchase.	- Stage Adoption playbooks opened & completed (QoQ) - Use case health scores
EBRs are strategic touchpoints to ensure that progress against desired business outcomes is being made and communicated back to the team that we work with and key influencers/decision-makers.	EBRs completed within the last twelve months in 75% of all accounts
Use case maturity workshops & enablement sessions to ensure continuous adoption and identifying areas of improvement.	- CI and DevSecOps maturity scores - Use case health scores
Customer roundtables are industry specific events organised and facilitated by the Customer Success Manager. Those events are meant to give customers the opportunity to exchange ideas and solutions around industry specific topics, such as regulatory requirements. Roundtables can also span industries if they share common use cases.	One roundtable per industry per quarter.

Expand & Renew

This phase is about going beyond a customer's primary use cases, into additional adoption/expansion and tier upgrades if applicable. Through ensuring a customer gets to value quickly, understanding a customer's desired business outcomes, and engaging strategically through touchpoints such as EBRs in addition to cadence calls, a CSM is a trusted advisor to introduce and advocate for the idea of growth. This phase also includes the preparation for upcoming renewals.

| Description | Metrics |

|---|---|

| Expansion Discovery | - Expansion playbooks opened (QoQ) |
| Expansion enablement & workshops | - Expansion playbooks completed (QoQ)
 - Days per

playbook completed per stage (QoQ)
 - Win rate for expansion playbooks (QoQ) |
| Renewals and health management | - Renewal rate
 - Regular CSM Sentiment health score
logged |

Account Engagement Expectations

Beginning FY25, all customers aligned with a CSM are considered Priority 1 and should be reflected as such in Gainsight and in our engagement model. That model is described below.

Cadence Frequency

CSMs should have weekly or biweekly calls with each of their customers, and should never go more than one month without a call. If a customer is unengaged, they should be marked as non-engaged and triaged appropriately. Even if it ends up being a false positive, we want to act swiftly to ensure any risk is mitigated. CSMs should expect to have 5-7 cadence calls per week, in addition to adhoc calls such as workshops, EBRs, product discussions, etc.

EBRs

All customers will have at least one Executive Business Review per year, and some customers may have EBRs twice a year or even quarterly. Each CSM should maintain an EBR roadmap for their book of business so they can plan in advance and begin working on scheduling and prep early on. CSMs are expected to report on their progress throughout the year on EBRs for each of their customers.

Workshops

The goal of workshops is to intentionally drive adoption and usage with our customer base, to ensure they are getting full ROI out of GitLab. A general framework for CSMs to adopt is to have at least one workshop per quarter with each of their customers. Across their book of business, on average, a CSM should expect to lead at least 2 workshops per month.

For any customers who have low usage, we should aim to have regular workshops with them focused on areas of the product that they have not yet fully adopted, or where additional training would help adoption of other features. For customers that have healthy use case adoption, we should still be ensuring they remain enabled on GitLab, by providing workshops focused on one of the following: reinforce core GitLab capabilities, share new product capabilities and best practices, help them adopt one area of the product better, or to expand into a new group that hasn't adopted GitLab yet.

Targeting workshops based on customers' current adoption allows us to be more strategic in our efforts of deepening product adoption and our partnership with our customers as their trusted advisors.

Success Plans

CSMs are expected to maintain success plans for each of their customers and update them, at minimum, quarterly, to reflect progress made against objectives and the plans for the coming year. These success plans need to be validated by both the customer (via the mutual success plan deck) and the CSM's manager (via Gainsight), in order to ensure alignment.

Account Growth Plans

In the AMER CSM motion, CSMs are typically able to spend more time with their customers and work with multiple teams and stakeholders in the organization. The CSM is also able to work with multiple subsidiaries and build comprehensive account knowledge. This leads to valuable insights on the customers' strategic business goals and future roadmap. To accelerate a customer's adoption and growth with GitLab, the Account Growth Plan helps to consolidate the information and builds a baseline for multiple GitLab internal stakeholders, including product, sales, and executive sponsorship. To quantify an investable customer initiative with data, the Account Growth Plan builds the single source of truth and contains objectives and actionable next steps.

The account team and regional sales leadership regularly review the current state of adoption, success plan objectives, and account plan details. The purpose is to build a shared understanding of the customer roadmap, align actions within the team, reduce potential adoption risk early, and share best practices within the account teams and region.

In addition to success planning, where the focus is on building a shared plan between the customer and GitLab on how the customer achieves their desired business outcomes, the Account Growth Plan includes actions to achieve growth and expansion within an account. The joint plans are used to bridge the gap between enablement into a strategic growth motion for internal collaboration.

Account Risk Management & Triage

CSMs are expected to regularly update Gainsight with health updates on the health of their customers. For red customers, a weekly update is expected, and for green customers a monthly update. Please see Customer Health Assessment and Management for full details of how to manage risk.

If a CSM has a customer in an escalated state, they are to follow the guidance based on escalation severity on how frequently to update the Slack channel.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/apj.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Overview

CSMs aligned with customers in APJ can use this handbook page to help define their processes and approaches that are unique to their segment.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/emea.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Introduction

This handbook page defines processes and approaches that are unique to CSMs aligned with customers in EMEA. For further information about CSM activities, responsibilities and strategy, please have a look at the AMER CSMs handbook page and the CSM Handbook homepage.

Org Structure

CSM EMEA is further divided into different regions. There are four different teams:

CSM SOUTH - responsible for customers in the south of Europe such as France, Italy and Spain

CSM DACH - aligned with customers in Germany, Austria and Switzerland

CSM NORTH - responsible for customers in northern Europe, for example in the UK and the Scandinavian countries

CSM META - manages customers in the Middle East, Turkey and Africa

CSA EMEA - responsible for Customer Success Architecture across the region

Team Contacts and Responsibilities

Michael Leutz is the director of CSM EMEA. Additionally, he manages the SOUTH, NORTH and META teams. The DACH team is led by Christina Souleles.

The GitLab SME collaboration requests project contains a list of the Subject Matter Experts within CSM EMEA.

Staff team - Specific experts / DRIs for EMEA CSM

Manuel Kraft

Sander Brienens

Regional Specific Details

Compared to AMER or APJ, the EMEA CSMs are further divided into four different regions within EMEA (SOUTH, DACH, NORTH and META). Due to the many different countries, cultures and languages within Europe, the Middle East and Africa it makes sense to have designated CSMs for each sub-region. This facilitates collaboration and cooperation with different customers and makes it easier to address the individual needs and expectations of each customer.

Meetings

Regular EMEA CSM Meetings

There are several meetings for all EMEA CSMs:

EMEA CSM & CSE Sync - biweekly on Mondays. In this meeting, announcements, changes, issues and learnings that are relevant for all CSMs in EMEA are discussed.

EMEA CSM Triage & CSE Office Hours - weekly on Tuesdays. CSMs can ask questions, discuss current problems and share insights.

EMEA CSM Social - weekly on Fridays. This is an informal and optional meeting without an agenda to chat with your coworkers.

Meeting Recordings and Summary

Zoom meetings can be recorded or summarized using the AI Companion feature provided by Zoom. Meeting Summaries allow the people who could not attend a call to quickly catch up on discussions, decisions and action items. This makes it easier for everyone to stay informed and enhances productivity and efficiency. The feature is turned off by default and can be enabled by the meeting host. The meeting host should always ask all attendees if it is alright to record or summarize the call. Additionally, all attendees will see a notification banner when Zoom call recording or Zoom AI Companion get enabled. This is especially important for customer meetings. If the customer does not want Zoom call recording or Zoom AI Companion to be used, the host should turn it off. We also have a section about call recordings in our Privacy Statement.

Slack Channels

There are multiple Slack channels for EMEA CSMs and for anyone who has a question to the EMEA CSM team:

emea-customer-success - anyone can ask questions, get advice, ask for help or share insights regarding customers and events in EMEA

team-csm-emea - for EMEA CSMs to communicate announcements, ask questions and share information

social-csm-emea - informal communication channel within CSM EMEA to share pictures, memes, funny stories and other content that might be interesting for the rest of the team

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/csa/_index.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

At GitLab, we understand that our customers' success is our success. That's why we have introduced the Customer Success Architect (CSA) role, our highest-rated technical product experts within Customer Success designed to provide you with the top-tier level of support and guidance throughout your journey with GitLab.

What can you expect from a Customer Success Architect?

The Customer Success Architect (CSA) is an experienced advisor who combines deep GitLab expertise with extensive DevSecOps knowledge to help you maximize your GitLab investment. Here's what you can expect from your CSA:

1. Strategic Expert Leadership: Your CSA brings extensive GitLab and DevSecOps expertise to help drive your strategy. They will:

- Design optimal solutions tailored to your specific needs
- Anticipate and address potential challenges

- Leverage their implementation experience to guide your success
- Work closely with you to understand and achieve your business objectives

1. Accelerator Program Implementation: Your CSA will lead focused 12-week accelerator programs aligned with your strategic goals. These programs provide:

- Structured guidance for implementing key initiatives
- Measurable outcomes through proven methodologies
- Implementation expertise in areas such as compliance, process optimization, and platform modernization
- Advanced tier receives up to 2 accelerators annually; Signature tier receives up to 4 accelerators

1. Advisory and Risk Management: Your CSA provides comprehensive guidance including:

- Product usage monitoring and optimization recommendations
- Risk assessment and mitigation planning
- Implementation guidance and best practices
- Regular progress calls (up to 4 per month for Advanced, as needed for Signature)
- Executive ROI Progress & Impact Reviews (up to 4 per year)

1. Cross-Functional Collaboration: Your CSA works closely with GitLab teams to ensure your success:

- Collaborates with Product Engineering to influence roadmap based on your needs
- Partners with your Assigned Support Engineer (ASE) (Signature tier) for enhanced support
- Coordinates with Education services to maximize your learning benefits
- Leverages their broad internal network to accelerate innovation

1. Knowledge Enhancement and Enablement: Your CSA drives excellence through:

- Customized enablement workshops tailored to your needs
- Guidance on certification paths and learning objectives
- Access to GitLab's extensive resources
- Support for maximizing educational benefits (40 certification vouchers for Advanced, 60 for Signature)

Your CSA is committed to your long-term success with GitLab. Through their deep expertise, strategic guidance, and dedicated support, they will help you unlock the full potential of GitLab's platform and achieve your DevSecOps objectives. Whether you're implementing new features, optimizing your workflows, or scaling your DevSecOps practices, your CSA will be your trusted advisor throughout your journey.

For Advanced tier customers, your CSA provides this comprehensive guidance along with accelerator programs and extended support coverage. Signature tier customers receive additional benefits including an Assigned Support Engineer (ASE), more accelerator programs, and enhanced support SLAs, creating a premium white-glove support experience.

How are you assigned a Customer Success Architect (CSA)?

A Customer Success Architect (CSA) is included with GitLab's Advanced and Signature Success Tiers. Each tier includes:

Advanced Tier

- Designated CSA
- Educational benefits (10% discount, 40 certification vouchers)
- Up to 2 accelerators per year
- 24x7 coverage for Severity 2 tickets (from May 2025)

Signature Tier

- Designated CSA and Assigned Support Engineer (ASE)
- Enhanced educational benefits (20% discount, 60 certification vouchers)
- Up to 4 accelerators per year
- 24x7 coverage and faster response times for Severity 2 tickets (2 hours vs 4 hours)

To get started with a CSA:

1. Contact your GitLab sales representative
2. Work together to determine the right Success Tier for your needs
3. Purchase either the Advanced or Signature Success Tier
4. Your dedicated CSA will be assigned to your account

Your CSA will serve as your consistent point of contact and work closely with your Assigned Support Engineer (Signature tier) and Education team to help you achieve success with GitLab.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/cse/_index.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Overview

At GitLab, we take customer success seriously, and our Customer Success Engineer (CSE) team plays a pivotal role in ensuring our global customer base receives unparalleled support and assistance throughout their journey with us. As a team, we oversee key processes (listed below) that are designed to empower our customers, enable our sales counterparts, and drive overall customer satisfaction. This aligns perfectly with the common pattern of being customer centric across our company strategy.

1\ Customer Enablement Webinar Program:

- Informative and interactive webinars for customers.
- Empowers customers with GitLab knowledge and skills.
- Live Q&A session providing immediate answers to customer questions.

2\ Customer Enablement Hands-on Lab Program:

- Help customers gain practical experience with GitLab's features.
- Interactive sessions with Live Q&A.
- Enhances adoption, productivity, and business goals.
- Direct interaction with CSEs fostering trust and collaboration.

3\ Pooled CSE Model:

- Collaboration with Account Executives and Renewal Manager on how the customer is adopting the platform, including any potential risks or areas for improvement.
- Offers technical expertise and support for high-risk or expansion accounts.
- Ensures top-tier attention, leading to retention and expansion.
- Drives ultimate customer success.

4\ Automated Email Campaign Process:

- Timely automated emails at key customer lifecycle points.
- Provides valuable insights, tips, and resources.
- Supports customer success and keeps customers engaged.
- Enhances communication and customer satisfaction.
- Email Content - GitLab Internal Only

CSE Operating Rhythm

The CSE operating rhythm outlines procedures CSEs use to engage with customers as well as how account owners can request CSE engagement outside of the normal operating rhythm during the customer lifecycle.

For the ARR thresholds for the CSE customer segment please reference this Wiki page (GitLab Internal).

The CSE DCI matrix provided below is designed to serve as a guiding framework to improve collaboration across teams. Please note that this is applicable only to accounts interacting with a CSE. For accounts managed by a CSM or CSA, refer to the CSMA's DCI on Rules of Engagement.

Journey Stage: Pre-Sales & Alignment

| Activities | Tasks | CSE | AE | RM | SA | PS | Support | Executive Sponsor | Product and Engineering |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| Identify Tech Champion(s) | Define and engage key user personas for solution tailoring. | I | C,I||DRI||||

| Sales to Customer Success (CS) Handoff | Ensure detailed information transfer from sales to CS for seamless transition. | I | C,I||DRI||||

Journey Stage: Onboard

| Activities | Tasks | CSE | AE | RM | SA | PS | Support | Executive Sponsor | Product and Engineering |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| General Advice for GitLab Setup and features implementation | As part of the onboarding campaign, an automatic post-onboarding email is sent by Gainsight. The customer can book a call with a CSE to go through their setup and needs. | DRI | C,I|||

| Technical Integration and Setup Support | Provide direct assistance setting up GitLab (for example, architecture and deployment strategies) to fit customers' needs and goals.

||C,I||C,I|DRI||||

Journey Stage: Enable

| Activities | Tasks | CSE | AE | RM | SA | PS | Support | Executive Sponsor | Product and Engineering |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| 1:1 Engagement with the customer, triggered by AE/RM, depending on the needs from the customer | Transactional engagement between the customer and the CSE to discuss a specific topic, which should be clearly defined by the AE/RM before the meeting with the customer. | DRI | C,I|||

| Conduct 1:N Workshops and Webinars focused on customer enablement | Organized workshops and webinar sessions hosted for different customers aiming to enable and help users with key product topics. |DRI|||

| Break'n'fix scenarios where there is a bug/the platform not behaving correctly | Cases where the customer expects someone to troubleshoot a bug or help with a specific feature setup. (In specific situations, the Support Engineering might communicate and inform the CSE about the support ticket)|(C,I)|||DRI||

| Measure Primary Use Case Adoption | Track and analyze the adoption rate of primary use cases when associated to requests originated from Renewals Managers or Account Executives.|DRI|||

Comments: (C,I) - It will depend on the situation.

Journey Stage: Expand

| Activities | Tasks | CSE | AE | RM | SA | PS | Support | Executive Sponsor | Product and Engineering |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| Expansion Discovery | Identify and pursue upsell and cross-sell opportunities. | (C) |DRI||C|||

| Account Health Checkups | Conduct regular assessments of account health to ensure ongoing

customer success. | (C) |DRI|C,I|C||||

Comments: (C),(I) - It will depend on the situation.

Journey Stage: Optimize & Renew

| Activities | Tasks | CSE | AE | RM | SA | PS | Support | Executive Sponsor | Product and Engineering |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| Business Review (BR) | Conduct BRs to review successes, challenges, and future plans.
|C|DRI||C||C,I||

| Renewal Discussions | Initiate early discussions about renewal, leveraging insights from the customer journey.|C,I|C|DRI|C||||

| Monitor Client Satisfaction | Implement a structured feedback process to capture and act on customer insights, driving continuous improvement.||DRI|C,I|C,I|(C)||||

| Facilitate Product Collaboration | Clearly capture customer needs via feature requests to assist Product Managers with feature prioritisation and product enhancement.|C,I|C||DRI||||C,I|

| Ongoing Risk Review | Active management of risk in a customer account, quickly turning a customer to red when there is any potential risk of contraction or churn and frequently updating the status.|C,I|DRI|C,I|C||C,I||

| Escalation Management | Trigger/leading the escalation process (account escalation / STAR) where needed.|C,I|DRI|C,I|C||C,I|C,I||

Comments: (C), (C,I) - It will depend on the situation.

For an additional overview of our CSE team-specific responsibilities, please reference our Job Family: CSE Responsibilities & Requirements

<i class="fa-solid fa-book" style="color: B197FC;"></i> CSE Content Handbook

Content/1:many is a critical part of our strategy to drive customer adoption at scale across our very large book of business. This requires dedicated resources/DRI to execute this strategy.

To learn more visit our CSE Content Team Handbook page.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/cse/cse-dris.md

Global organization

The CSE organization is a global organization and so are the themes, initiatives and processes. Therefore it can be difficult to be aware of who is the DRI for specific topics and this page should help solving this issue.

Table of DRIs and the associated CSE leadership sponsor

Topic / Initiative / Process sponsor	DRI	CSE Leadership
----- :-----: -----		
--:		
Field process for Risk Accounts (AMER)	@cguitarte	AMER CSE lead
Field process for Risk Accounts (EMEA)	@jconrad2	EMEA CSE lead
(@esivak)		
CSE campaigns	@nesplin	@afrusciano
CI Product Coach	@jconrad	@ofalk
Security Product Coach	@cguitarte	tbd (@esivak)
CSE Labs (collab with the Content Team)	tbd	tbd
CSE Webinars (collab with the Content Team)	tbd	tbd
CSE Roles / Job family definitions	@ofalk	@afrusciano
CSE Enablement	@jconrad2 + @cguitarte	@ofalk
CSE Escalation process	@cguitarte	@ofalk
CSE Tools: Calendly	@ofalk	@afrusciano
CSE Offerings Catalog	@jconrad2	@afrusciano

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/cse/cse-operating-rhythm.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM/CSE-related handbook pages.

--- CSE Team Customer Engagement Types

There are several different ways that the CSE team engages with customers, including:

1. Targeted campaigns run from Gainsight
1. Monthly Webinars and Labs
1. Sales Driven CSE Engagement Request

Targeted Campaigns

Customer Success Operations and CS leaders determine, based on various GitLab health metrics, a set of outreach campaigns to drive customer interactions that will help improve GitLab adoption and usage. Examples of campaigns are:

- 21 day check in
- 90 day low license utilization
- CI product coach

Existing campaign email drafts can be found in the Automated CSE Campaigns Content google doc. The email campaigns get sent to a target group based on geo and ARR and typically contain the Calendly link for the specific CSE working with that segment.

Monthly Webinars and Hands On Labs

The CSE Team delivers monthly webinars and hands-on labs that are available to all. The webinar calendar is published to our website, with a registration link for each. Webinars are pre-recorded content with CSEs answering Q&A. Labs provide a hands-on learning experience for each attendee with their own lab environment to work through lab exercises during the session.

Creating Webinar Content

The CSE Team works with our content team to create content for our Webinars. In order to create, from start to finish a strong webinar content. We have guidelines and tips and tricks which you can follow over at this link [Webinar Guidelines for CSEs](#)

Preparing for and Delivering a Hands-on Lab

The upcoming month's hands-on labs are added to an issue in the Customer Success Engineering - Content Project (separate from the webinar schedule) and the CSE team is asked to sign up as DRIs.

Lab Environment Request

> As a Lab DRI, you are responsible for submitting a Lab Request for an environment. This should be submitted ideally at least one week before the date of delivery. For assistance/questions please reach out on the demo-architect-partners Slack channel.

1. Navigate and login to the Demo Architect Portal.
1. Select Content/Lab Request from the dropdown list.
1. For Salesforce Account Link, enter <https://gitlab.my.salesforce.com/Account/>
1. For Opportunity type, select CSE Led Lab.
1. Fill in the rest of the form to the best of your knowledge.
1. Click Submit Request.

This will result in an Issue being created on the Demo Architect - Workshop Management Board which will be picked up by the Demo Architecture team.

A pair of invitation codes, one for production and one for testing will be generated and shared in a comment on the issue. The Demo Architecture team will assign DRIs ownership of the session (Top level group) and verify invitation codes and associated runners are operational.

Lab attendees will redeem the invitation code when joining the lab to secure access and provision their subgroup to use for the hands-on exercises, accessed through gitlabdemo.com. Each slide deck has detailed instructions for the attendees that the host will guide them

through to create the subgroup and access it.

Lab Preparation

Before the event, the host should make a copy of the appropriate master slide deck and store it in the 2. Global Onboarding Labs -> Decks -> Delivered decks folder, with the Title: <Lab Name> - <Region> - Date. In the lab deck, change the registration codes to match the current lab, and add their name and profile picture to the presenter slide.

The CSE Program Manager will handle all pre-lab and post-lab communication with the attendees, and will request the Highspot link to add to the post-lab email.

The lab content is contained in the GitLab Learn Labs Sample Projects group. The correct project should be linked in the slide deck you are using for the lab. The host should run through the lab exercises in their entirety at least once before the event to ensure there are no technical issues.

You should also create a paste notes doc that has all of the information and links that you will want to put in the chat for the lab participants. See Sample Paste Notes for Security and Compliance Lab. Provide the link in the scale-workshops-planning slack channel for anyone who is helping with Q&A. The scale-workshops-planning slack channel is used for any pre-lab questions, set up, demo environment issues, etc.

On the day of the lab, the host should login at least 10 minutes prior to the lab start to get set up.

Lab housekeeping items - these should be called out in the lab slide deck as well:

- all attendees are muted - ask participants to stay muted and add their questions in the Q&A panel
- an account on gitlab.com is needed before starting
- access to lab environment for x days (it's 2 days for some labs and 4 days for others - should be called out in the appropriate slide deck)

Tips and tricks for presenting:

- open 2 chrome windows side by side when working through labs - one with the issue instructions and one with the lab project you're using to work through each step
- put your slides in full screen presentation mode for presentation
- turn off all notifications
- hide your bookmarks bar and be conscious not to share anything related to other customers
- go slower than you think you need to through the exercises

After the lab, the CSE Program Manager will send a post-event email with a link to the recording and slide deck.

Reporting an Issue with Content

When reporting a problem, use the Bug template in the Content project, then fill out as much of the information as possible.

CSE Engagement Request Process

Account owners (AEs, SAEs, Renewals Managers) working with customers that qualify for CSE may find that their customer would benefit from a CSE engagement outside of the normal operating rhythm during the customer lifecycle (programmatic call invitations from Gainsight, manual outreach by CSE in Outreach, Office Hours and Webinars). In these cases, it is best to submit ad-hoc engagement requests through Salesforce.

To open a new CSE case, go to the customer's account in SFDC and select the Opportunity the case will be associated with. On the Opportunity page, click the CS Help button. On the next page, you will be asked to select an option between CSE Help (NOT Escalations) and Escalations (CSM/CSE Accounts). Select the CSE Help option (for Escalations, please check this section). The next step will ask to provide information about the case. In the On-Demand Catalog Offerings dropdown, select the service that best aligns with the customer's needs. Below, you have a detailed description of what each offering covers. Next, add the Contact whom the CSE will be speaking with.

The other mandatory information is a detailed description of what is expected from this engagement. Please add all relevant information in the Challenges/Pain Points field. It is crucial for the CSE to have a clear understanding of the customer's situation so they can prepare appropriately for the meeting.

This brief screencast demonstrates how to reveal the CS Help button when on the customer's opportunity page in Salesforce:

After the case is created, it will be automatically listed in related case lists on both the account and opportunity. Then, a corresponding Call to Action (CTA) is generated in Gainsight for the CSE to handle. But it is not real-time (batch rule runs every four hours starting at 12:30-1 am PT everyday).

NOTE: Unless specified otherwise, CSEs will automatically reach out to the contact with the AE/RM in copy when cases are created. If the AE/RM does not want that to happen they can put a note in the open text "Challenges/Pain Points (1000 Character Limit)" field on the case.

- For more information about the scope and qualifications for CSE engagement, refer to the following links:

- CSE: Qualifications/Scope Document for CSE Engagement
- CSE Workflow - Process
- CSE Highspot page

CSE Catalog Offerings

The CSE Catalog provides a structured framework of engagement offerings that support customer technical needs across different GitLab areas. When submitting an engagement request to the CSE team, Account Executives (AEs), Renewal Managers (RMs), and Solutions Architects (SAs) can select from these offerings to best match the customer's specific requirements. Each offering is designed to address distinct technical challenges and implementation scenarios, allowing for more focused and effective CSE engagements. Below are the detailed descriptions of each available offering:

- Fast-Track GitLab Implementation: DevOps leads and platform administrators will receive

expert guidance on how to accelerate their GitLab deployment. The CSEs will share concrete setup recommendations covering configuration, user management strategies, and documentation based best practices.

- Optimize Your GitLab Architecture: Enterprise architects and technical leads will receive expert guidance on designing a robust, scalable GitLab infrastructure. The CSEs will share best practices on architectural patterns, including high availability configurations and disaster recovery strategies that reduce downtime risk.
- Streamline Your CI Workflows: Engineering leads and DevOps teams will learn strategies to enhance their CI pipeline performance and resource utilization. CSEs will analyze the customer's gitlab-ci.yml configuration and share optimization patterns to reduce build times and best practices for job efficiency, caching strategies, and pipeline architecture to improve overall CI performance.
- Strengthen Your Application Security: Development and security leads will discover how to automate and streamline security practices across their pipeline. CSEs will share strategies for implementing automated scans, enforcing security policies, and managing vulnerabilities efficiently using GitLab's security features.
- Transform Your Workflow with AI: Development teams and technical leaders will learn how to leverage GitLab Duo to accelerate their entire software development workflow, improve code quality and deliver more secure applications. CSEs will share strategies for implementing AI-assisted features across planning, code suggestions, and security scanning based on successful implementations.
- Optimize Your Migration Strategy: Technical leaders and migration teams will learn proven strategies for moving to GitLab from their existing tools. CSEs will share migration approaches, technical prerequisites and limitations, architectural considerations, and risk mitigation tactics based on successful transitions at similar organizations.
- Accelerate Your Software Delivery: DevOps teams will discover how to streamline their continuous deployment processes for greater reliability. CSEs will share best practices for deployment automation, environment configuration, and release management drawn from enterprise implementations.
- Strengthen Your GitLab Operations: System administrators will learn proven strategies for managing their GitLab environment at scale. CSEs will share best practices for authentication, user management, group organization, and project configuration based on enterprise implementations.
- Optimize Your Platform Observability: Platform engineers will gain insights on optimizing their GitLab monitoring and observability practices. CSEs will share monitoring strategies for setting up basic system monitoring, implementing advanced observability, garbage collection statistics, and resource utilization tracking.
- Scale Your Agile Planning: Project leaders and delivery teams will learn how to leverage GitLab's planning capabilities for better visibility. CSEs will share strategies for implementing effective workflows using issues, epics, and iterations while measuring progress through value stream analytics.

Tracking Ad-Hoc CSE Engagements in Gainsight (CSEs only)

When a CSE has accepted an engagement request, the CSE must then create a CTA in Gainsight for proper tracking and CSAT survey deployment post-follow-up email.

- Create CTA from the Cockpit with the following details
 - Name: [Customer Name] - Ad-Hoc CSE Engagement Request
 - Company: [Customer Name]

- Type: Digital Journey
- Reason: Other Digital Journey Reason
- Priority: (select the most appropriate type based on the request)
- Playbook: One-Off CSE Outreach

Note that the trailing " - Ad-Hoc CSE Engagement Request" MUST be there in order for us to generate proper metrics. The customer name can be truncated in order to satisfy the "Name" length requirements. Once the call is complete, the call must be logged as an activity against the customer's timeline in Gainsight using the CSE Engagement meeting type in Gainsight, and filling in the relevant details regarding the customer meeting details.

The CSE should then prepare a follow-up email to be sent to the customer through the email-assist in the task: Follow Up Email Post One-off CSE Outreach Call Completion

This ensures that a CSAT survey is deployed to the recipients of the email.

General Guidelines for CSE Engagements

Playbooks

A list of Playbooks can be found on the CSE Playbooks sub page.

CSE Escalations

Qualifying the customer for an escalation is important in terms of ARR and LAM. ARR should be $\geq 80\%$ of the ceiling for your segment's ARR range. LAM ought to be $> \$100K$. Another very weighty criterion is an upcoming renewal. If they are ≤ 3 months away from an upcoming renewal, an escalation could help turn their frown upside down.

Escalations ought to be used sparingly and only for the larger accounts in our segment with a high potential for growth so that our support, product, and engineering teams can prioritize their efforts in good alignment with overall GitLab business objectives.

There are two types of escalations: support escalations and account escalations.

1. Support escalations are for existing tickets causing a very high business impact for the customer and is raising their temperature very high. The escalation process can bring attention to the issue and raise its priority within support. Following the defined process for a support ticket escalation noted on the Support ticket attention requests page is sufficient.
1. Account escalations may or may not relate to a support ticket. It could be relevant to an open issue for a product bug or a feature request. It's useful when the customer communicates a highly-impactful problem relevant to, for example an open issue that is blocking a critical use case and causing them to evaluate other vendors for non-GitLab solutions and is thus posing a churn or contraction risk for GitLab.

Meeting Workflow

Meetings are integral to interfacing with customers; whether we are joining a call with an Account Executive or driving the call ourselves. We must do what we can to prepare ourselves and ensure that the call is as productive as possible. This will require having some resources

available to leverage when needed. The following can serve as a loose guideline for preparing for customer meetings.

1. Meet with the AE, if possible, prior to call to get more relevant context around customer's wants, needs and other particular details.
1. Create a Notes document
 1. Prepare some go to questions tailored around what information you may have gathered from researching the customer or speaking with the AE. Include any relevant customer concerns, states, tech stack, etc (usually derived from AE custom deck or AE directly)
1. Create a Slide Deck.
 1. Ensure Notes and Slide Deck are in the Customers & Prospects under appropriate Company name.
1. Ensure that the Zoom/Chorus link is correct in the meeting invite.
1. Research company:
 1. in Salesforce/SFDC
 1. in Gainsight
 1. Notable data:
 1. Number of Licenses
 1. Number of Employees
 1. Key Personas
 1. Industry
 1. Duration of contract/last renewal date
1. Locate and study Custom Pitch Deck from AE (find Custom Pitch Deck link in Salesforce Opportunity or reach out to AE directly)
 1. Perform general research of the company and related industry to give better context.
1. Reach out to AE/SAE and let them know about the meeting; discuss strategy, insights. Add AE/SAE as optional to all calls.
1. Join the call at least 10-15 minutes early to prepare and be ready to allow customers to join from the waiting room.
1. Confirm that Chorus is recording and that customer is aware (usually informed through the Calendly invite)
1. Ensure quick discreet access to:
 1. Notes
 1. Slide Deck
 1. GitLab features for reference
 1. Any other pertinent resources for quick reference (See Appendix of CSE - Kickoff / Discovery Questions Template for ideas)
1. Make sure to manage expectations about short term engagements and not being permanently aligned.
1. After the call is complete, set expectations for follow up email in the upcoming 2-3 days.
1. Once the call is complete, the call must be logged as an activity against the customer's timeline in Gainsight.
1. Review call and/or sync with AE if applicable and produce follow up email for customer.

Follow up

CSE should follow up with the customer within 2-3 business days after the engagement. This follow-up should include:

1. A summary of the key points discussed during the meeting
2. Any action items or next steps agreed upon

3. Relevant resources or documentation that may be helpful for the customer
4. An invitation for the customer to reach out with any additional questions or concerns

The CSE should also update the CTA in Gainsight with the outcome of the engagement and any important notes for future reference. If there are any outstanding items that require further attention, the CSE should create appropriate follow-up tasks or escalate to the relevant teams as needed.

It's important to maintain clear communication with the account/opportunity owner (AE/RM) throughout this process, keeping them informed of the engagement's progress and any significant outcomes or concerns.

Additional questions from the customer after the follow up mail

If a customer has additional questions after receiving the follow-up email, the CSE should:

1. Respond promptly to the customer's inquiries, ideally within 1 business day.
2. Provide clear and concise answers to their questions, including any relevant documentation or resources.
3. If the questions require more in-depth discussion or demonstration, offer to schedule a brief follow-up call.
4. Update the CTA in Gainsight with the new information and any additional actions taken.
5. Keep the account/opportunity owner (AE/RM) informed of any significant developments or concerns raised by the customer.
6. If the customer's questions reveal a need for ongoing support or engagement, discuss with the account owner about the possibility of extending the CSE engagement or involving other GitLab teams as appropriate.
7. Ensure all interactions and outcomes are properly documented in Gainsight for future reference and to maintain a comprehensive record of the customer engagement.

Important Notes:

- If the topic the customer wants to address is a new topic, a new request shall be opened to clearly distinguish the different topics/requests. We also consider anything that comes up after more than 4 weeks a new request.
- Rule of thumb: We don't want to exceed more than 3 follow ups about the same topic.
- Please do not reopen requests from the previous quarter, even if it's related to the previous topic, it may result in unintended consequences in regards to our metrics.

If the customer comes back with additional questions to the AE or RM, please feel free to redirect them to the CSE who had the call previously with the customer.

CSE Useful Link Signpost

QBR : Template / CSE Cases Dashboard / CSE Manager Dashboard

INITIATIVES : All Initiatives / Initiatives Needs Help / Comments assigned to me / Initiatives Board

SIGNPOST : Find Product Slack Channels / CS Tools / Version Metrics / Metrics Dictionary Sheet + Tool

1:MANY : Adoption Labs Master Decks / Webinar Master Recordings / Webinars Youtube / Scale

Webinars Dashboard

COACH : CI Product Coach playbook / CI Coach Report / Security Coach Playbook / Pipeline Parser / Security Coach Common Topics & Recommendations

DEMO : Demo Cloud / Shared Demo Systems Doc / Sandbox Cloud / CS Shared Demo Space

TRAINING : DevSecOps Bootcamp Nana / New CSE Learning Path

USEFUL APPS : Rectangle / Amphetamine

CSE Lunch & Learn Recordings : Recordings

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/cse/cse-tm-onboarding.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Overview

As a Customer Success Engineer (CSE), your onboarding experience will be a blended learning experience that includes virtual synchronous meetings, a self-paced role-based learning path on GitLab University, and a hands-on virtual workshop called Sales Quick Start (SQS).

Your role based learning path is highlighted in this role-specific onboarding guide. Please make a copy of this document and check off items as you complete them.

Learning Objectives for CSE Onboarding

As a CSE, in addition to the SQS learning objectives, your onboarding is intended to fulfill the following learning objectives:

Module 1: CSE at GitLab and Call Shadowing

- Demonstrate understanding of GitLab Basics
- Express the Customer Success Vision
- Describe the role of CSE
- Complete the following certification: GitLab Certified Git Associate
- Express understanding of the DevSecOps Lifecycle
- Demonstrate ability to set up a GitLab demo environment

Module 2: CSE Deep Dive

- Describe the rhythm of business for a CSE
- Demonstrate comprehensive understanding of CI/CD
- Apply understanding of CI/CD
- Complete the following certification: GitLab Certified CI/CD Associate GitLab CI/CD
- Demonstrate customer readiness by completing role play exercise

Module 3: Technical Deep Dive

- Explain best practices for customer onboarding
- Examine reference architecture

- Demonstrate comprehensive understanding of GitLab Agile Project Management
- Complete certification GitLab Project Management
- Demonstrate customer readiness by completing role play exercise

Module 4: CSE Best Practices

- Formulate comprehensive understanding of the DevSecOps adoption
- Identify how to request and track CSE engagement
- Differentiate rules of engagement for the CSE and other account team members (i.e., AEs, SAs, CSMs, etc)
- Apply use of Gainsight
- Demonstrate comprehensive understanding of GitLab Security
- Complete certification GitLab Security Specialist
- Demonstrate customer readiness by completing role play exercise

Module 5: CSE Onboarding Conclusion

- Explain CSE Escalations
- Identify recommended CSE meeting workflow
- Discuss customer readiness with your manager
- Complete Sales Quick Start prework
- Complete role-based onboarding learning path

Milestones and Onboarding Roadmap

Expectations for Manager Support during Onboarding

Your manager will be there to support you during your onboarding journey. Beyond the expectations laid out for your manager in your onboarding issue, they will be providing you with the following support:

Month 1

- Schedule recurring 1:1s and check in calls
- Provide guidance on who the new hire should schedule coffee chats with during their onboarding journey
- Review and discuss company policies
 - PTO policy
 - Family and Friends first culture
 - CREDIT Values
- Discuss any team specific expectations
- Review organizational structure
- Ensure new hire has access to all role-specific tools and appropriate Slack channels
- Align on a general plan to get customer ready including who to schedule your onboarding role plays with
- Ensure new hire is meeting appropriate milestone and expectations from week to week
- Identify skills to be mastered and resources available to accomplish learning objectives

Month 2

- Check in regularly with your new hire
 - Ask them if they are experiencing any challenges with GitLab's asynchronous culture
 - Discuss any general concerns
- Share constructive feedback on role plays that were completed during the onboarding learning path
- Ensure onboarding milestones are met and that new hire is completing required courses and certifications
- Align on whether your new hire is on track to be customer ready and how else you can provide support to get them ramped
- Discuss best practices and rules of engagement for CSEs

Month 3

- Decide on a regular cadence for 1:1 calls
- Prep your new hire for taking over assigned customers/accounts
- Consider shadowing some customer calls and provide feedback as needed
- Confirm that new hire has completed all mandatory and necessary onboarding activities including SQS and role-based learning path
- Discuss how their performance will be formally evaluated

Beyond 3 months

- Provide regular feedback on performance
- Partner with employee to develop an individual growth plan for goals they want to achieve in the coming year
- Discuss the following topics at length in the coming months by providing an overview of the topic, why is it important to customer / GitLab / CSE, what does good look like, what are some common pitfalls, and how success is measured:
 - Cadence Calls
 - Success Plans
 - EBRs
 - Customer Escalations
 - Customer Enablement
 - Gainsight Hygiene

Expectations for Buddy Support during Onboarding

Month 1

- Nurture a welcoming environment for the new hire
- Establish a recurring 1:1 meeting to check in on the new hire's progress on onboarding activities
- Provide assistance with any barriers or difficulty understanding concepts covered in the onboarding learning path and SQS
- Connect the new hire with members of the broad team to build a network
- Share helpful tips and resources that are beneficial during their onboarding and beyond

Month 2

- Provide opportunities for new hire to shadow you on calls as defined in the shadow criteria and assist with note taking
- Debrief on calls and discuss feedback
- Align with new hire's manager on ways you can provide support

Month 3

- Co-lead calls with the new hire until they are ready to take over customer interactions independently
- Share constructive feedback
- Inform new hire on how you can support them beyond their onboarding journey

Graduation from CSE Onboarding

In order to be considered as having graduated from your CSE onboarding journey, you need to have completed the following:

- Completed Sales Quick Start (SQS) prework on GitLab University
- Attended the SQS workshop and completed all relevant activities
- Completed your role based learning path on GitLab University
- Attained the following certificates:
 - GitLab Certified Git Associate
 - GitLab Certified CI/CD Associate
 - GitLab Certified Project Management Associate
 - GitLab Certified Security Specialist
- Completed role play activities and discussed feedback with your manager / onboarding buddy

Continuous Onboarding

For high level information on enablement initiatives for the Customer Success Manager/Engineer teams, please refer to the CS Enablement Corner. Additionally, please be sure to check out the CS Development Handbook page.

Be sure to join the Customer Success Skills Exchange and Field Enablement Spotlight sessions.

Feedback

Your feedback on the onboarding process is important to us and we welcome your thoughts and ideas about how we can improve in the future. Please share your feedback in the following issue: CSE Onboarding Feedback.

Resources

- CSE - New Hire - Onboarding Guide
- Customer Success Engineer (CSE) Onboarding Learning Path
- Sales Quick Start (SQS) Handbook Page
- customer-success Slack Channel
- Customer Success Enablement Issue Board
- CSE Onboarding Feedback Issue

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/cse/customer-onboarding-best-practices.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM/CSE-related handbook pages.

Onboarding Best Practices Deck

During onboarding it's critical to ensure customers have confidence in foundational areas to ensure their continued success. The areas we've identified are:

- Best practices for setting up group/project hierarchy
- User authentication and authorization
- Early DevSecOps adoption

This should be covered in the initial technical onboarding call with the customer, for instance the 21 day check-in call for CSEs. The deck (internal link) provides open ended discovery questions to learn more about customers' plans, progress and most importantly confidence in these areas. By learning about their goals and how confident they are in their progress we can provide them with the best enablement resources (webinars, documentation, videos) to create a solid foundation they can build upon.

The deck covers both self-managed and SaaS.

Preparation for Onboarding call

1. Make a copy of the deck (internal link)
1. Add your name and role to the title slide
1. For Ultimate customers hide the Security and Auditing (GitLab Premium) slides
1. For Premium customers hide the Security and Compliance (GitLab Ultimate) slides

Resources

- Deck (internal link, make a copy)
- GitLab Issue with discussion on creation of the deck
- Group and Subgroup hierarchy
- SAML SSO for GitLab Groups (SaaS)
- SAML SSO for Self-Managed GitLab Instances
- Integrate LDAP with GitLab (Self-managed)
- Get Started with GitLab Application Security
- Holistic Approach to Securing the Development Lifecycle (webinar recording)

SECTION: customer-success/csm/segment/cse/content/_index.md

fa-solid fa-door-open Welcome to the CSE Content Handbook

<i class="fa-solid fa-signs-post" style="color: B197FC;"></i> QuickLinks

Team Workflows, Planning and Collaboration

<!--

Issue Boards

- *<i class="far fa-clipboard"></i> Content Development*
- *<i class="far fa-clipboard"></i> Content Idea Backlog*
- *<i class="far fa-clipboard"></i> Program Development*
- *<i class="far fa-clipboard"></i> Release Management*

Roadmap

- *<i class="far fa-clipboard"></i> Customer Success Engineering Roadmap*

Team Resources

- *<i class="far fa-calendar-alt"></i> Webinar and Labs Calendar*

Want to work with the team?

- *<i class="far fa-edit"></i> Content Idea Template*
- *<i class="far fa-edit"></i> Raise Content Bug*

>

<i class="fa-solid fa-users" style="color: B197FC;"></i></i> Team members and focus areas

We are members of the Customer Success Engineering team.

| Team member | Responsibilities |

|-----|-----|

| Nicole Esplin
 Content Strategist | Cross Functional Collaboration, Content Strategy, Marketing/Promotion, Content Optimization, Content Delivery |

| Tearyne Almendariz
 Content Architect | Quarterly Planning/Backlog Management, Content Creation (Non Demos), Content Operations |

| James Wormwell
 Demo Architect | Content Creation (Demos), Demos/Lab Content Creation, Demo Operations, Demo Asset Maintenance |

<details>

<summary>

Responsibility Detail

</summary>

> Note: The following RACI chart can be used to understand how content creation stakeholders interact on each area of Responsibilities listed above. The table will continually be updated

as the team evolves and matures.

Content Team Responsibilities Matrix

| Responsibilities | Content Strategist | Content Architect | Demo Architect |
|---|--|-------------------|-----------------------|
| CSEs | CSSO | CSE Leadership | |
| ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- |
| ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- |
| ----- | ----- | | |
| Cross Functional Collaboration -: maintain alignment with other content stakeholders - EDU, Field Marketing, SAs, DevRel | | | |
| | DRI | | Consulted |
| Consulted | Informed | Informed | Consulted |
| Content Strategy: - oversee strategy and execution for driving GitLab adoption at scale thru multiple content delivery methods (aligned with CSE quarterly goals/initiatives) | | | |
| | DRI | | |
| Consulted | Consulted | | |
| Consulted | Informed | Consulted | |
| Quarterly Planning/Backlog Management: - organize and maintain visible backlog ensuring content creation is aligned with strategy/quarterly objectives. | | | |
| | Consulted | | |
| DRI | Consulted | | Informed |
| Informed | Consulted | | |
| Marketing/Promotion: - create and execute internal and external strategies designed to maximize visibility, engagement and impact through various channels | | | |
| | DRI | | |
| Consulted | Consulted | | |
| Informed | Informed | Informed | |
| Content Creation: - develop and execute against content strategy. Work with SMEs to ensure workback plan for delivery | | | |
| | Consulted | | DRI (Webinars, blogs) |
| DRI (Labs) | Consulted | Informed | Informed |
| Demos/Lab Content Creation | | Consulted | |
| Consulted (decks, talk tracks, delivery) | | | |
| | DRI (structure, architecture, messaging) | | Consulted |
| Informed | Informed | | |
| Content Optimization: use data to refine and enhance content performance, reach and engagement across various channels. Includes creation/iteration of email text and monitoring effectiveness of campaigns | | | |
| | DRI | | Consulted |
| Consulted | Informed | Consulted | Consulted |
| Content Delivery: oversee scheduling and ensure the right SMEs are delivering in the most impactful manner | | | |
| | DRI | Consulted | |
| Consulted | Informed | Informed | Consulted |
| Content Operations: Updating GLU Calendar (Thought Industries), Zoom registration process and uploading of all content. Also management of email campaigns in GS. | | | |
| | Informed | | |
| DRI | Informed | | |
| Informed | Consulted | Informed | |
| Demo Operations -: manage demo codes for hands on labs. Collaborate with architecture team for CSE needs (SA DAs to cover for PTO) | | | |
| | Informed | | Informed |
| DRI | Informed | Informed | Informed |
| GL Release Management -: update learn labs after each GL release. Create monthly TLDR for CSE org to be used across all content delivery. Update content assets that change due to releases and ensure CSE or understands value and talk tracks as applicable | | | |
| | Consulted | | |
| Consulted | DRI | | |
| Informed | Informed | Informed | |

</details>

<i class="fa-solid fa-book" style="color: B197FC;"></i> Content Catalog

The Content team creates content that will be maintained and can be reused for customers to consume.

You can search for relevant content and contact the team in the linked content projects or in the cse-content-team Slack channel.

The following sections provide an overview of all content assets, and links to find them.

Environments/Infrastructure to support Demonstrating Content

- Build Your Own - Self service public cloud infrastructure/tooling/environments. Individual AWS account or GCP project access documented in the Sandbox Cloud Realm handbook pages and accessed through gitlabsandbox.cloud.
- Use Cases:
 - Competitor analysis/demonstration/exploration
 - Personal runner/fleet demonstration/exploration
 - Self-managed deployment
 - Customer environment simulation
 - Self maintained deployment target(s)
- Self-Managed - Shared Customer Success Omnibus instance cs.gitlabdemo.cloud (internal) with visibility of Admin areas accessed through gitlabdemo.cloud, maintain